

Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The reasoning process :

To determine the least developed part of the brain at birth , we need to consider the developmental timeline of the brain . The brain develops in a hierarchical and sequential manner , with different regions maturing at different times . The most primitive and essential functions , such as breathing , heart rate , and reflexes , are controlled by the brain stem , which is responsible for the most basic life-sustaining functions . The brain stem is the oldest part of the brain and is fully developed at birth . In contrast , the more complex functions , such as higher-order thinking , decision-making , and language , are associated with the cortex , which is still developing throughout childhood and adolescence . The other options , such as the thalamus , basal ganglia , hypothalamus , parietal lobe , and limbic system , are also involved in various functions , but they are not as essential for basic survival as the brain stem . Therefore , the least developed part of the brain at birth is the part that is responsible for the most complex and higher-order functions , which is the cortex .

Considering the options provided , the cortex is the part of the brain that is associated with the least developed part at birth , as it is still maturing and refining its functions during the early stages of life .

</think><answer> G . cortex </answer>

